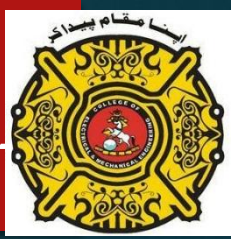




Professional Ethics



DR. MUHAMMAD ZEESHAN MIRZA

LECTURE – 3

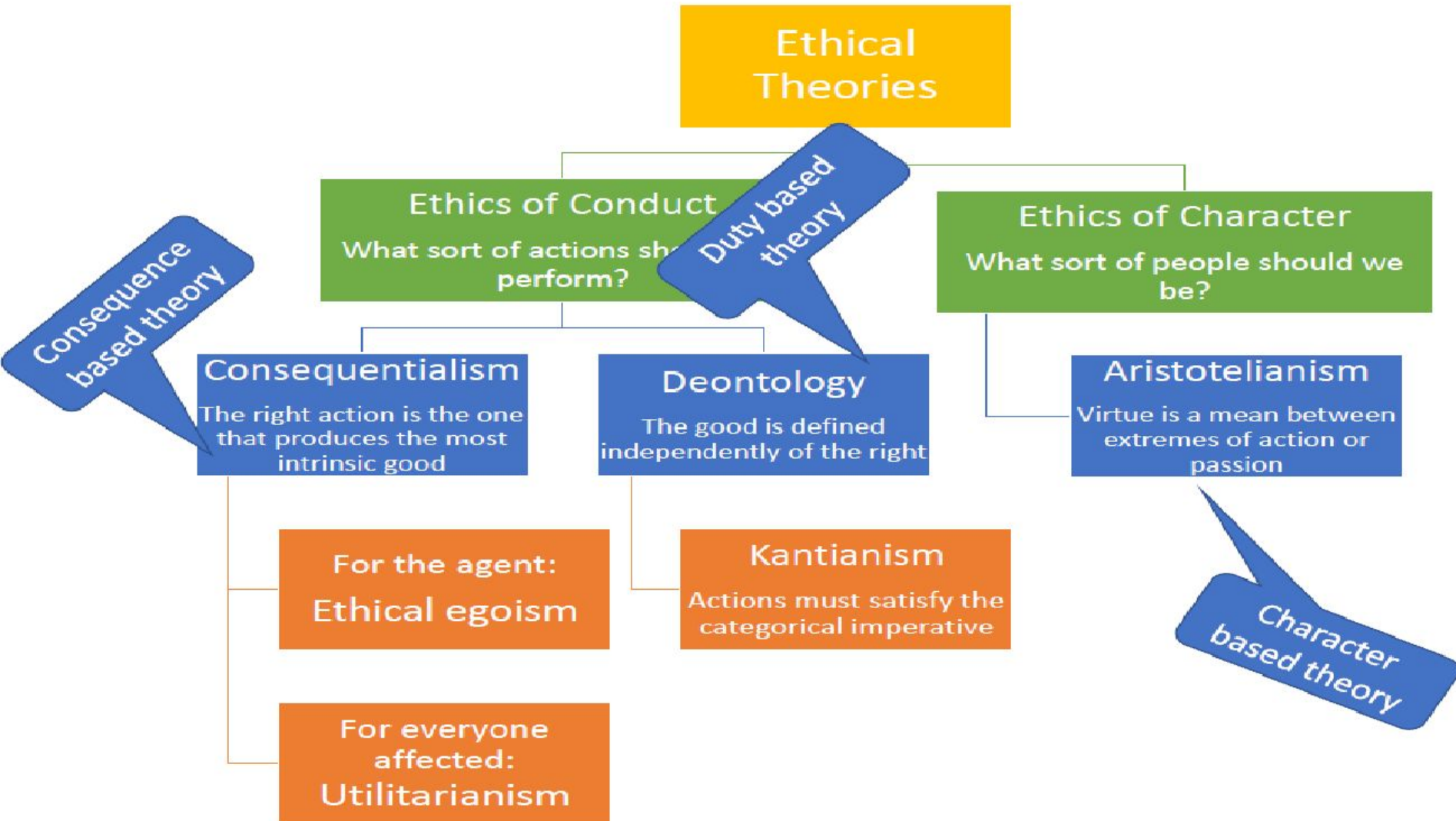


Course Information



Course Name	Professional Ethics
Course Code	HU-222
Credit Hours	2
Email	zeeshanmirza21@hotmail.com
Visiting Hours	2-4 pm

Ethical Theories



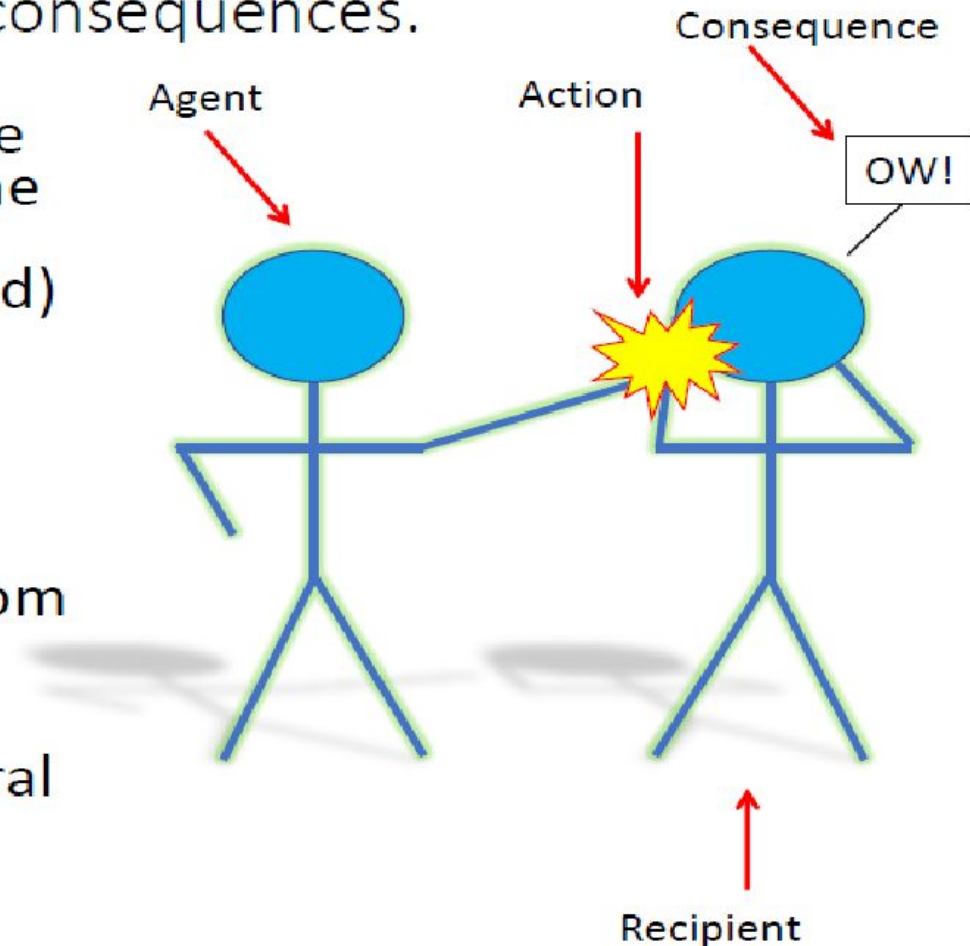


Consequence based Ethical Theories



Ethical situations generally involve (1) a moral agent, (2) an action or series of actions, (3) consequences, and (4) a recipient of the consequences.

1. **Moral Agent:** Responsible for action (the doer, or the actor, to which praise or blame is typically assigned)
2. **Action:** Something that occurs as a result of the moral agent's decision making process
3. **Consequences:** Result from action
4. **Recipient:** Receives the consequences of the moral agent's action(s)





Consequence based Ethical Theories



- ▶ Bentham (1748-1832) and Mill (1806-1873)
- ▶ What results from an act
- ▶ The ends justify the means
- ▶ Principle of social utility measured by the resulting amount of happiness



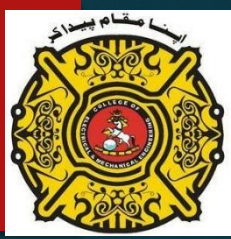
Utilitarianism



- ▶ **Act utilitarianism** – Act is good if it results in the greatest good for the greatest number
 - What happens to minority?
- ▶ **Rule utilitarianism** – Act is good if it comes from following rules that bring good to greatest number



A Case to Discuss



- ▶ Suppose you are on an island with a dying millionaire. With his final words, he begs you for one final favor:
- ▶ “I’ve dedicated my whole life to baseball and for fifty years have gotten endless pleasure rooting for the New York Yankees. Now that I am dying, I want to give all my assets, \$2 million, to the Yankees.”
- ▶ Pointing to a box containing money in large bills, he continues: “Would you take this money back to New York and give it to the Yankees’ owner so that he can buy better players?”
- ▶ You agree to carry out his wish, at which point a huge smile of relief and gratitude breaks out on his face as he expires in your arms



A Case to Discuss



- ▶ After traveling to New York, you see a newspaper advertisement placed by your favorite charity, World Hunger Relief Organization (whose integrity you do not doubt), pleading for \$2 million to be used to save 100,000 people dying of starvation in Africa. Not only will the \$2 million save their lives, but it will also purchase equipment and the kinds of fertilizers necessary to build a sustainable economy. You decide to reconsider
 - ▶ **What is the right thing to do in this case?**



A Case to Discuss

Traditional
Moral
Principles

1. "Let your
conscience be
your guide"

2. "Do
whatever is
most loving"

3. "Do to others
as you would
have them do
to you."





Deontology



- ▶ The word 'deontological' comes from the Greek deon, meaning '**obligation**', '**necessity**', '**that which is binding**'
- ▶ Generally speaking, those words translate as '**duty**', so deontological theories tell you what your moral duties are



Deontology



- ▶ If the act is morally wrong no amount of positive consequences can make it right. Even if the moral agent (the one acting) is a saint, because the act itself is wrong, the saint who engages in that action remains morally wrong





A Case to Discuss



- ▶ A millionaire makes a dying request for you to donate \$2 million to the Yankees. You agree but then are tempted to give the money to the World Hunger Relief Organization instead.
- ▶ What should you do?



A Case to Discuss



- ▶ The deontological answer to this question, is not the consequences that determine the rightness or wrongness of an act but certain features in the act itself or in the rule of which the act is a token or example
- ▶ The end never justifies the means
- ▶ There is something right about truth telling and promise keeping even when such actions may bring about some harm



A Case to Discuss

- ▶ If you decided to act on the principle of keeping promises, then you adhered to a type of moral theory called **Deontology**
- ▶ If, on the other hand, you decided to give the money to the World Hunger Relief Organization to save an enormous number of lives and restore economic solvency to the region, you sided with a type of theory called **Consequentialist ethics**

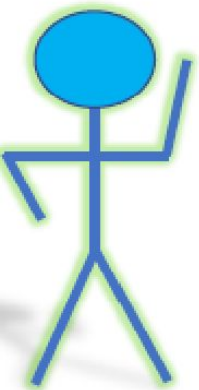


A Case to Discuss

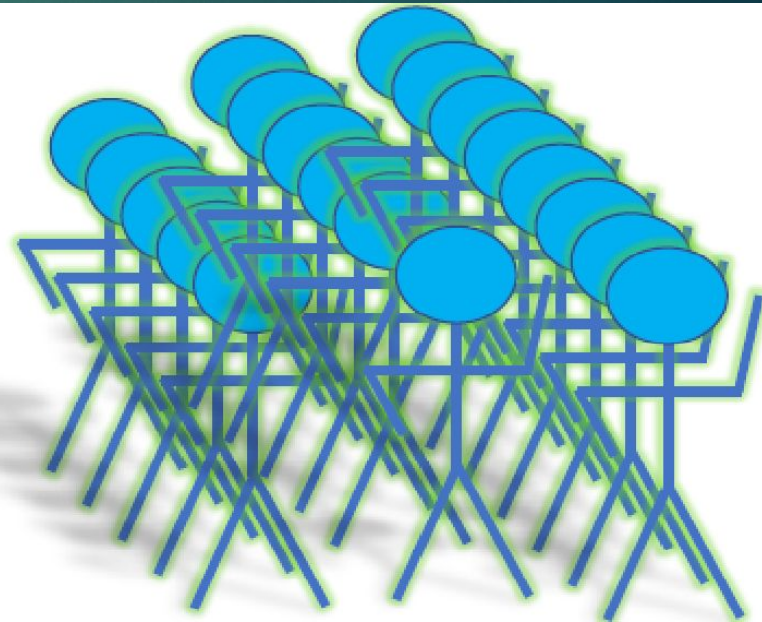
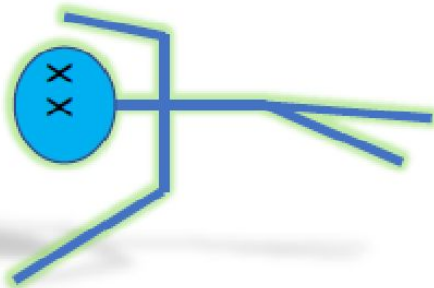


“Terrorists capture Bilal and twenty companions. The leader of the terrorists makes Bilal the following proposition:

“If you shoot just one of your friends, I will let the others go free. If you do not, then I will kill them all.”



Again, under utilitarianism, this is ethical...right?





Virtue Theory



- ▶ **Virtue ethics** emphasizes the role of one's character and the virtues that one's character represents for determining or evaluating ethical behavior
- ▶ Virtue ethics place an emphasis on **being rather than doing**
- ▶ Another way to say this is that in virtue ethics, morality stems from the identity and/or character of the individual, rather than being a reflection of the actions (or consequences thereof) of the individual



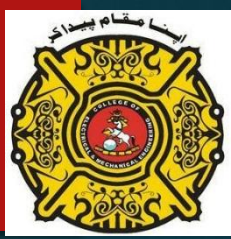
Virtue Theory



- ▶ A virtue ethics philosopher will identify virtues, desirable characteristics, that the moral or virtuous person embodies
- ▶ Possessing these virtues, in virtue ethics, is what makes one moral, and one's actions are a mere reflection of one's inner morality
- ▶ “Morality is internal. The moral law . . . has to be expressed in the form “be this,” not in the form “do this.” . . . The true moral law says “hate not,” instead of “kill not.” . . . The only mode of stating the moral law must be as a rule of character”



Difficulties with Virtue Theory



- ▶ There is a great deal of disagreement within virtue ethics over what are virtues and what are not
- ▶ There are also difficulties in identifying what is the "virtuous" action to take in all circumstances, and how to define a virtue
- ▶ A system of virtue theory is only understandable if it includes an account of the purpose of human life, or in popular language, the meaning of life



What is required to live a virtuous Life



Virtues	Vices
Honesty	Dishonesty
Courage	Cowardice
Compassion	Insensitivity
Generosity	Selfishness
Loyalty	Disloyalty
Integrity	Sleaziness
Fairness	Unfairness
Self-Control	Self-Indulgence
Prudence	Short-sightedness



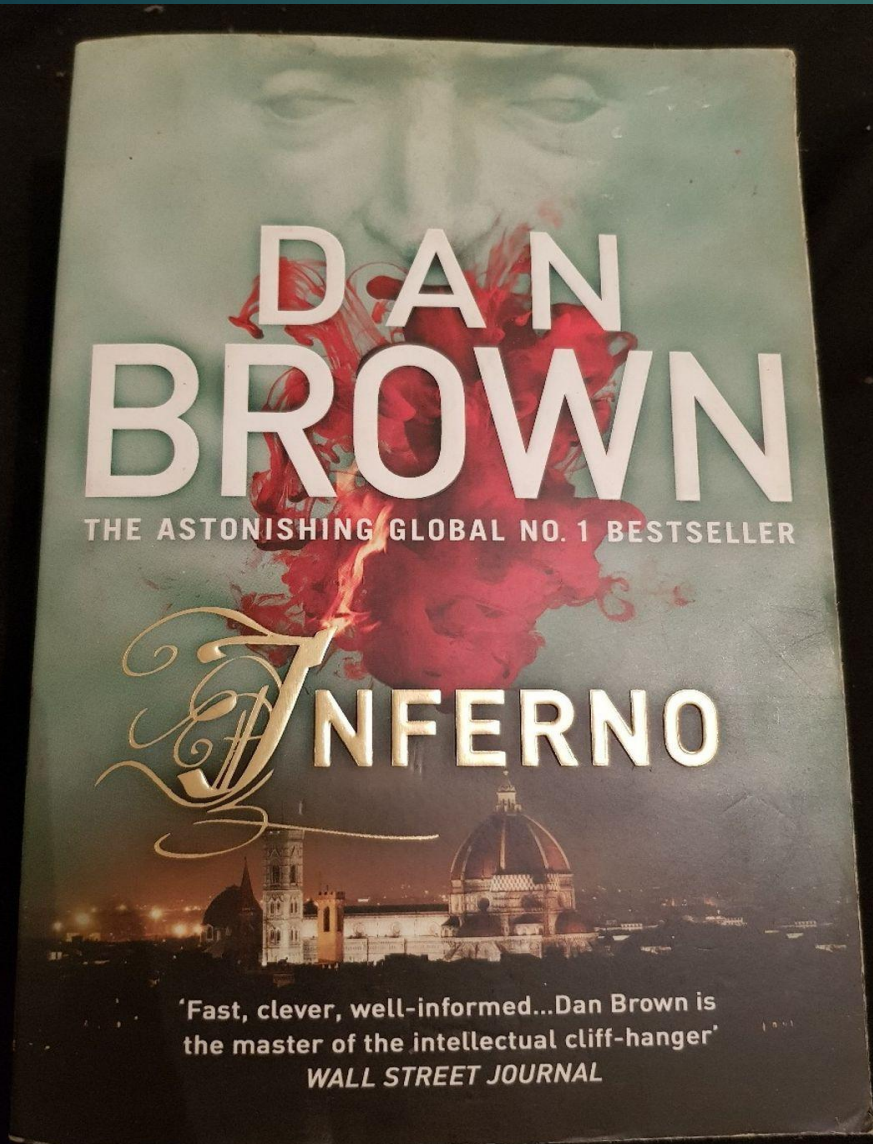
A Case to Discuss



- ▶ Hamid and Ammar each have the opportunity to embezzle 10 million rupees from the bank at which they work. Ammar never even considers embezzling; the possibility is not an option for him. Hamid wrestles valiantly with the temptation, almost succumbs to it, but through a grand effort of will finally succeeds in resisting the temptation



A Friendly Suggestion



THANK YOU.....

